

Pros and Cons of Varying Programming Methods for Intensity

	Percent of 1RM	RIR / RPE
Pros	• Assessment of maximal strength • Practical for many free-weight, compound exercises • Periodic retests may increase motivation and serve as a form of positive reinforcement that the client is making progress	• Enhances individualization for well-trained/experienced lifters • Inherently adjust based on acute readiness and performance capabilities that day • Inherently accounts for progressive adaptations in strength performance one experiences • Does not require maximal strength testing • Easily implemented for any exercise • Potentially more sensitive to controlling the magnitude of effort
Cons	• Inherent risk of injury • Less suitable for novice clients • Strength performance is highly variable based on many factors • Maximal strength can drastically change in a short period of time, thus programming off a percentage of a lift from weeks ago • Drastic individual differences in repetitions one can perform with a percentage of their 1RM • Potentially uncomfortable and/or unrealistic to perform dependent on exercise, equipment availability	• Novice clients struggle to accurately predict and assess RIR • Becomes more difficult to accurately predict when working with lighter relative loads/higher repetition ranges • If clients never train to RIR 0/RPE 10, their ability to accurately use RIR likely decreases • Varies based on loading intensity/repetition range as well as exercise type • May promote clients to omit training to failure indefinitely